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December 21, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Political Science and Economics
Rowan University
Glassboro, NJ
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the tenure-track faculty position in Economics in the Department of Political Science and Economics at Rowan University. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Rowan University's emphasis on high-quality undergraduate instruction, applied learning, and public engagement makes it a strong fit for my interests and training. The department's placement within a broader social science unit creates valuable opportunities for interdisciplinary teaching and research, particularly in areas where economic analysis intersects with public policy. I am especially drawn to Rowan's mission as a public university that combines accessibility with a growing commitment to research and scholarly activity.

Teaching. I have experience teaching and supporting courses in *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomics*, and quantitative methods. My teaching philosophy emphasizes clarity, economic intuition, and the use of data to connect theory to policy-relevant and real-world outcomes. At Rowan, I would be well prepared to teach introductory and intermediate economics courses, including macroeconomics, as well as applied or quantitative electives depending on departmental

needs. I place a strong emphasis on student engagement, structured problem-solving, and clear communication, particularly for students encountering economics for the first time.

I would be enthusiastic about contributing to Rowan University through teaching, research, and service, and about becoming an active member of the Department of Political Science and Economics. Rowan's focus on student success, applied learning, and community engagement aligns well with my professional goals and approach to academic work.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards